partners! The fact that I got them al together to share whatever little development had been achieved— results, experiences, smal successes, and the like—seemed to me worth putting al my energy and time into. It was a very smal price to pay for that commitment and sense of teamwork, which could in fact be cal ed trust. Within my own smal group of people I found leaders, and learned that leaders exist at every level. This was another important aspect of management that I learned.

We had modified the existing SLV-IV Stage design to suit the Diamont airframe. It was reconfigured and upgraded from a 250 kg, 400 mm diameter stage to a 600 kg, 650 mm diameter stage. After two years' effort, when we were about to deliver it to CNES, the French suddenly cancel ed their Diamont BC programme. They told us that they did not need our Stage IV anymore. It was a great shock, making me re-live the earlier disappointments at Dehra Dun, when I failed to get into the Air Force, and at Bangalore, when the Nandi project was aborted at ADE.

I had invested great hope and effort in the fourth stage, so that it could be flown with a Diamont rocket. The other three stages of SLV, involving enormous work in the area